# The Jewel Garland: A Commentary on the Difficult Points of the Tantra of the Glorious Lamp of Reality

Śrī Tattvapradīpaṃ Nāma Tantra Ratnamālā Pañcikā · Toh 1205 · Derge Tengyur
དཔལ་དེ་ཁོ་ནོ་ཉིད་ཀྱི་སྒྲོན་མའི་རྣམ་པར་བཤད་པ་རིན་ཆེན་ཕྲེང་བ།

The Jewel Garland, in full A Commentary on the Difficult Points of the Tantra of the Glorious Lamp of Reality, carries the Sanskrit title Śrī Tattvapradīpaṃ Nāma Tantra Ratnamālā Pañcikā and the Tibetan title Pal De Khona Nyi kyi Drönmé Gyü kyi Kadrel Rinchen Trengwa. It is a commentary on the difficult points of a tantra, the Glorious Lamp of Reality: after paying homage to Glorious Great Bliss, its author promises to make this supreme tantra clear according to its true meaning, distinguishing in due order the provisional and the definitive meanings that Vajradhara taught. Following the root tantra's dialogue between the Goddess and the Blessed One, it explains the inner yoga of the completion stage, including the joys, the sequence of appearances from which existence and nirvāṇa unfold, and the nondual wisdom of great bliss and the Great Seal, and it closes by warning against explaining the tantra to those without empowerment. Its colophon names the author as the great Indian master Mahāsukhatavajra and the translator as the monk Jangchub Jungné. It is Toh 1205 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of commentaries on the tantras.

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In the language of India: śrī tattvapradīpaṃ nāma tantra ratnamālā pañcikā
In the language of Tibet: A Commentary on the Difficult Points of the Tantra of the Glorious Lamp of Reality, Called The Jewel Garland

Homage to Glorious Great Bliss.

Nonabiding, free of all conceptual thought,
The very embodiment of all the buddhas,
Self-aware and inexpressible:
To that great primordial wisdom I bow.

This supreme unsurpassed tantra,
Which is not the domain of ordinary beings,
Since others have urged me with their requests,
I shall make clear according to its true meaning.

The provisional and the definitive meaning
That Vajradhara taught

I shall, for the sake of certainty, in due order,
Distinguish according to the true meaning.

Here are many vajra words,
The sublime reality, the meaning of the result.
A garland of wish-fulfilling precious jewels
Is by its very nature pervasive;
Accomplishing the defining mark of what is needed,
This commentary I have likewise made pervasive.

On the passage beginning "Thus did I hear": "Thus" refers to teaching the faultless way exactly as it is. "I heard" means that it was heard by the compiler alone; it did not come about through a chain of transmission or by hearing it from someone else. To dispel error, it means that it was heard from Vajradhara alone. "At one time" means at the time when he was dwelling with his retinue in the bhaga of wisdom. Moreover, that special and fitting circumstance is the one time when he was dwelling together with a retinue of heroes and heroines. He is called the Blessed One because he has vanquished the four kinds of māras, or else because he possesses excellent qualities. The tathāgatas are the sugatas of the five families and so on. Distinguished by family, they have come from great bliss itself in order to act for the benefit of those to be trained. Alternatively, they are those gone to suchness: the buddhas Vairocana and the rest. "All" gathers in all the tathāgatas, however many there are, without exception, as illustrated by the grains of sand in the river Ganges.

"Body, speech, and mind vajra" means that, since the body, speech, and mind vajra of all the buddhas is the very nature of the Blessed One's body, speech, and mind vajra, he is Vajradhara. The bodhisattvas, and likewise those dwelling in the form of goddesses, are the great heroes and the sovereign heroines. In the manner of those who abide on the ten grounds, the bodhisattvas, a retinue emanated from himself, dwell surrounding the Blessed One; they dwell in a special celestial palace within the bhaga of wisdom, whose nature is the expanse of phenomena (dharmadhātu). This is what is meant by saying that the Blessed One, the embodiment of the three bodies, dwelt together with his retinue.

On the passage beginning "There the Blessed Lady": in that place where he dwelt, she pleased the Blessed One in various ways in order to make a request. The passage beginning "She made this request" is her question.

Others say that these are to be explained in terms of an inner meaning and so on. That is contradictory, and since it would corrupt the word of the tantra, it should not be taught. The passage beginning "The Blessed One declared" was spoken.

Here, "evaṃ mayā" is also called the binding vow (saṃvara), because all the meaning of the tantra is gathered in it. Here it is taught in brief; it is taught at length later in this very text. In other tantras, in terms of the meaning of the binding vow, these four syllables are said to be applied to wisdom and method, āli and kāli, the four cakras, the goddesses and the four moments, the four joys, the four realities, the four truths, the four schools, the staff, and so on. Elsewhere there are also presentations even more extensive than that. Even so, they must be explained without contradiction.

The words "and so forth" take in everything up to "dwelt," that is, from "Thus did I hear at one time" up to "dwelt in the bhaga of wisdom." The word "constituents" refers to the elements: earth, water, fire, and wind. "The three realms of existence," whose nature is endowed with body, speech, and mind, are the desire realm, the form realm, and the formless realm, each a realm of its own; thus there are three. "Moving beings" are the sentient beings of the five classes; "the unmoving" is the nature of the container world. Alternatively, "the unmoving" refers to the buddhas, the bodhisattvas, and so on. "The four kinds of seal" are wisdom, and the method endowed with it is the primordial wisdom of things. "By intrinsic nature" means that they abide pervaded and sealed by the joy of intrinsic nature itself. Moreover, that is the sublime essence of all; because it abides in all, they are sealed. That which conceptual thought cannot carry off, by its intrinsic nature radiant and free of conceptual elaboration, is what is meant by "All are sealed, and not by another." As it is said:

At the close of making Brahmā's battlefield,
You, well pleased, set down your seal firmly
And sealed the countless;
Therefore you are renowned as the Great Seal.

"The stainless, perfect result itself": if it is divided into synonyms, it has many, such as "result," "reality," "the supreme," "unborn," "unceasing," and so forth; but its essence is nondual primordial wisdom, great bliss itself. Because this tantra shows it clearly, it is said to be known as the Lamp of Reality.

As for the extensive teaching of its meaning: in the passage beginning "Thus did I hear," "evaṃ" is called the tantra of method and wisdom. Tantra is that which abides permanently as a continuum. Method and wisdom are the father and mother: the form having the nature of body, speech, and mind vajra, together with bliss. Body is the major and minor marks; speech is the form of syllables; mind is the forms of the bodhisattvas; and the vajra nature is a particular kind of bliss. This is the tantra inseparable from the Blessed One Vajradhara. Method takes such forms as the precious vajra, whose meaning is the awakening mind (bodhicitta). Wisdom takes the form of the one who has the lotus, according to the sequence of distinctive places. As it is said:

The fair shape of the letter e,
Richly adorned at its center with vaṃ,
Is the casket of buddha jewels,
The ground of every bliss.

By the word "mayā," it is the compiler herself, the Blessed Lady, who heard it; and that is the form of the body and so forth.

Moreover, on the passage beginning "Thus by me, the three realities": in terms of these divisions, namely the digit (kalā), which is divided into three, that is, the nature of the syllables together with the vajra whose nature is body, speech, and mind, the nature of the moon, and camphor; the drop (bindu) and the mode; the compiler; and the outer place and so on, together with the tantra: just as the tantra was taught after the Blessed Lady had first urged the Blessed One, so here too it came to be heard through urging and requesting. Rising from the center of the secret lotus, she urged the Blessed One of great bliss, and so it was heard, or came to be understood, as being the nature of the body, speech, and mind vajra. That is "the moon, supreme bliss, heard": the experience of the form of joy. In terms of body and so forth, these are the three joys: of emanation, of perfect enjoyment, and of Dharma. Being endowed with intrinsic nature, great bliss, is what is meant by:

Together with its very self,
In the distinctions of the four natures.

Not radiating out from the vajra itself, accompanied by the joy of intrinsic nature and the mere mode, is the ultimate of the result, free of conceptual elaboration. Of this it is said: "It should be known as the ultimate."

The words "the moon, supreme bliss" are explained as the place, the bhaga of wisdom: the place differentiated through the sequence of outer and so forth.

Going into that special place is cessation. Because it has become the power of wisdom, it is "supreme over others," that very place. That the Blessed One and all his retinue have one and the same place is the meaning of what was heard. Because it does not abide in either of the two extremes, existence and nirvāṇa are abandoned. That is, being without the conception of two joys, the father and mother, method and wisdom, being inseparable, is "free of the two." The inconceivable time, free of good and bad, is the time endowed with nondual wisdom. It is that very thing which is called "the Great Seal, free of generation and completion." Even so, the name of the result is applied to the cause. Therefore it is said:

The Blessed One is called the End,
The actual experience of the joy of intrinsic nature.

Alternatively, the digit, because it is endowed with supreme subtlety at the place of the root lotus; the drop itself, in the form of camphor, the awakening mind; and the mode, which is that very thing, because wisdom is clear: these are called the three realities. The mere mode is the union with the wisdom of various aspects; its white form, in which bliss greatly increases, is "the moon, supreme bliss." Because it is in essence the sealing of the natures by that very thing, it is the Great Seal. Being unstained by their faults is "supreme over others." Because the joy of intrinsic nature itself is the culmination of all joys, it is "the end"; this means that those wisdoms are conventional. Likewise, too, at the soles of the feet is the digit, and at the heart, the place where the drop dwells, is the mode: these are the three realities. At the immeasurable place is the mere mode, endowed with the supreme moon. At the place of mind, the wheel of Dharma, is "supreme," the nature of the Great Seal. At the place in the center of the wheel of enjoyment is "the end," the essence of "supreme over others." At the place where the moon is full is "complete," which means the joy of intrinsic nature, the embodiment of the three bodies, beyond expression.

In the Jñānatilaka Tantra, however, it is not taught in this way. Others say: "It is taught by way of the indestructible nature at the heart, in terms of the three realities and so on; then, in stages, it is taught in the wheel of enjoyment; and then it is completed in great bliss. That is, first, from the embodiment of the three realities abiding at the heart, rays of light radiate upward; by them the moon melts, and the bliss that arises is "the moon, supreme bliss" and "the Great Seal"; in the wheel of Dharma it is "the end" and "supreme over others." That is the sixfold yoga of generation. Doing that, as taught earlier, in the

wheel of enjoyment and so on, means the completion of the sixfold yoga."

"All is the three wisdoms, emptiness" means that all phenomena of existence and nirvāṇa, as soon as they dawn through the sequence of three aspects, are empty of conceptual thought. Moreover, for sentient beings too, who possess all such things as the aggregates, the channels, and the form of seminal fluid, there is arising and presence through the sequence of the three appearances; this is the nature of saṃsāra. This is explained below, where it is presented clearly. Even so, it is "all" because of the appearance of the wisdom of the three joys, taught in terms of the channels of body, speech, and mind. The gradual diminishing of conceptual thought is "empty," the wisdom of emptiness. The abandonment of the appearance of conceptual signs is "empty"; this is what is meant by "It is abandoned by that itself."

"Tathāgatas" are the buddhas, the five aggregates and so on. By the word "aggregates" is meant consciousness, the awakening mind, which has come from suchness, from the place of radiant light. Moreover, through the sequence of the three appearances it goes forth as the vajra emanation, the fourth nature, and it goes back again to its own place. "Renowned as the Discerner" refers to the discernment that distinguishes, within the three, the understanding in which habitual tendencies are present. "Fully accomplishes the first place" means that, having come forth from great bliss with the characteristics of the form body, he goes again into the radiant light that is the nature of great bliss; in meaning, his going into the wheel of great bliss is "the first place." That is, the aggregates and everything else have become great bliss. The body is to be distinguished in terms of outer and so on. Likewise, the presentation of before and after is to be abandoned. Through seeing the body, it has become the essence of joy. There, through method and wisdom, conceptual thought about the male and female organs ceases; since it does not arise, there is "freedom." The word "arisen" means that it is also free of conceptions about substances such as seminal fluid. Likewise, the stages of the joys of bliss and so on mean the abandoning of conceptual thought that relies on the four seals. "The body, speech, and mind vajra of all the tathāgatas": because it is made by the Blessed One himself, it is the mind of the joy of intrinsic nature and so on. Moreover, it is to be distinguished according to the stages of the path.

On the passage beginning "The goddess, the great mighty one, born of the sun": the words "great heroes" refer to the bodily forms of the bodhisattvas. Likewise, the glorious goddesses are also taught, and that itself is explained

as: the āli and the root sequence; the sixteen drops of the awakening mind; the wheel of channels of the heroines. Likewise, at the navel are the sixteen drops of the awakening mind, and on the right and left, two sets of sixteen, are the heroines, the channels themselves. The hero is supreme joy and the heroine is the joy of separation; they are free of melting, emission, and loss.

The hero is the awakening mind, camphor, and the heroine is the essence of the navel; by intrinsic nature they surround the Blessed One. "Fully surrounded" means surrounded by the channels, which are the forms of the deities and so on, and by the syllables of the awakening mind and so on. "Limbs" refers to the gathering of all of these.

"Like a lotus by the pervading water" is said because they possess the intrinsic nature of the principal deity; it is akin to an illustration by example.

"That wisdom is the abode of Brahmā": abode, support, and basis are synonyms. It is a special kind of abode, one free of conceptual thought. Here the lunar intrinsic nature of the awakening mind is called Brahmā. Therefore it says, "Brahmā, because it holds gnosis." Holding gnosis in the joy of separation is holding it in the joy of intrinsic nature.

As for "bhaga, because it conquers the māras": sleep, torpor, doubt, and regret are the māra of the sons of the gods. Attachment and the like are the afflictions. Illness and the like are the māra of the aggregates, and the cessation of life and of the faculties is the māra of the Lord of Death. Here the conquering of the entities of conceptual thought is done by the Blessed One who is the joy of intrinsic nature. "Or else, because it experiences enjoyments" means that when the one whose nature is endowed with the six enjoys taste and gnosis, the Blessed One (Bhagavān) and bhaga are one in meaning. These are the outer and the inner processes.

"The very characteristic of dwelling" refers to the major marks, the minor marks, the syllables, and so on, which were explained earlier. "Thus abiding, or else gone" means that abiding through the power of the commitment is the same as dwelling, while "gone" is in the sense of the gnosis being (jñānasattva). These are to be distinguished by the aspect of body, and by speech, mind, and the bliss that is the intrinsic nature of the vajra.

As for the passage beginning "In such an ultimate sense": in the definitive meaning, whatever stages of method one relies on, one finds the ultimate fruit; here it is attained through the meaning of "Thus have I heard" and the rest. The passage beginning "All is secret in the yoga tantras" means: in the

Action, Conduct, and Yoga tantras, by way of the words; in the Higher Yoga and Unsurpassed Yoga tantras, by way of the definitive and the provisional meaning. The rest is easy to understand.

The passage beginning evaṃ refers to the generation of gnosis together with the sequence of the sites of the channel wheels that are endowed with the jewel and the lotus of the father and mother, method and wisdom: the sixty-four petals, the eight, the three, and all of these. This is called the source of phenomena (dharmodaya), the ground on which Vajradhara dwells. The awakening mind, the joy of intrinsic nature, holds sway over all the grounds free of conceptual elaboration. In the tantra it is said:

The ground of the emanation body is always the eleventh;
The complete enjoyment body, the twelfth;
The Dharma body is the thirteenth;
The fourteenth is great bliss;
The ground that is the fifteenth
Is taught to be the ground of gnosis.
The sixteenth ground is beyond examination.

It is taught at length in this way, and it says:

All of these, through the distinctions of joy,
Are designated by the word ground.

There, the sequence in the passage beginning "That which is the essence of the three realities" should be understood from what was said earlier and from the context. The arising, three times over through joy and supreme joy, of the gnosis of consciousness endowed with śukra (semen) is taught as that very reality, in the sense of mind, mental factors, and ignorance. The distinctions among its blazing, melting, and dripping, its enjoyment, and the joys, and likewise among the watches, the transits, the water-clock periods, and the daṇḍas, are explained with reference to the inner process. The intrinsic nature of the gnosis of ignorance comes to arise, and from the sequential arising of these, reality becomes clear. Or else, it is taught that from the joy of separation reality itself becomes clear there. That, moreover, is twofold, good and bad, and finding the good meaning is the fourth. Thus it is said:

Just as a jewel in the darkness
Is not seen if there is no lamp,
So too reality
Is found through the stages of the path and the rest.

All phenomena are entities of conceptual thought, and these are conquered and made void by reality alone. This is applying the name of the result to the cause.

Some hold that the life force is the vital wind and that the staff is the awakening mind. Others say that the awakening mind is the life force and that the staff is the channel. Here, however, the distinction to be made between the outer and inner channels is this: even merely by holding the vital wind and drawing it into the place of the joy of intrinsic nature, the thirty-two channel knots and so on are one in the taste of the experience of gnosis, and so there reality is likewise free of conceptual elaboration.

Arising through the sequence of the three joys is the threefold generation stage, and going upward is the threefold completion stage; this is the meaning of the sixfold yoga. Or else, it is the meaning of the completion stage at the site of the utpala lotus. In the sense of supreme joy and the joy of separation, there are rising and setting, disappearance and enjoyment, together with the characteristics of wind and the awakening mind. It is also explained with reference to the joy of intrinsic nature itself. From the meeting of wind and the awakening mind, the varieties of joy, joined with the joy of intrinsic nature, shift into the upper and lower petals: this is mastery over the mind in the place of joy, and through the sequence of supreme joy and the rest, great bliss dawns. When channel and awakening mind are joined and set in a special site, the joy of intrinsic nature is found, and so that is the flourishing of the body and the other limbs.

The sequence of the stations of the vase empowerment, the secret empowerment, the wisdom-gnosis empowerment, and the fourth, endowed with joy and the rest, is the sequence of empowerment. Because, in the mind that has the aspect of joy and is accompanied by the fruit of the fourth empowerment, the joy of intrinsic nature conquers the māra of the joy of annihilation, this is explained as the supreme protection wheel. Its borders of vajras, jewels, and so on are the emblems of the Tathāgatas. Moreover, some masters hold, on the basis of the text, that by dividing each of these it becomes eight-cornered and is further expanded step by step; if one has faith in that, it should be adopted. I, however, do not hold it so, and from here on I make its meaning clear.

The passage beginning "The supreme gnosis of the great secret": "secret" refers to what is not to be taught. Its essence is fully liberated from all

conceptual elaboration. If even merely by hearing and understanding this supreme great gnosis, which is not the domain of activity of the śrāvakas and the like, one becomes a lord of the grounds, what need is there to mention reflection and meditation? One will attain the inexpressible ground. If one attains it even without diligence, what need is there to mention one who has diligence? This is an expression meaning "without doubt."

The passage beginning
"That which is this very heart mantra
Is the bliss of the sixteenfold nature"
refers to the heart mantras such as oṃ that come from the mantras of the āli and kāli, the vowels and consonants; likewise the heart mantra in the form of the syllables of the awakening mind set at the sites of the body and so on; likewise the heart mantra of the mind, arising from joy and the rest; and likewise the ultimate mantra of the ground where the two, wisdom and method, meet.

The passage beginning
"That which is the offering of the eight bodies
Is the eight supreme signs"
refers to the signs of meditating on the generation stage with respect to the sites such as Jālandhara, which are the sacred sites (pīṭha), the fields (kṣetra), and so on; the eight signs of the eight bodies of the awakening mind at the eight sites of the body, the crown of the head and the rest; and the signs of the gnosis of the eight bodies in the eight-petaled lotus with its anthers. These mean that they arise from the two, father and mother, method and wisdom.

The passage beginning
"That which is disappearance, enjoyment, and mastery
Is like the generation stage"
refers to the generation that concerns the body; likewise the generation in the body from the awakening minds; and the producing of the three, joy and the rest, through the sequence of the secret vajra-jewel. It means the dawning of the reality of intrinsic nature, and so on. That itself is the great bliss of the fruit.

The passage beginning
"Fortunate lady, that which is the gnosis body
Has now abandoned the stages and the other limbs"
refers to the body of great gnosis that is free of approach and

accomplishment, such as generating the gnosis body of the Blessed One who is great bliss, and free of the six limbs, and that has abandoned the nature of all the limbs: the limbs such as the wheel of the body, and the limbs of joy and of union, such as the secret vajra-jewel at the wheel of emanation. Supremely subtle, unchanging, inexhaustible, neither arising nor ceasing, having abandoned all conceptual thought, it sports forth from the great gnosis of bliss itself.

The passage beginning
"O Goddess, that which is the word 'secret'
Is free of the three gnoses":
"secret" means not being the domain of those without commitments, and so on. From the gnosis being, which is free of the three, body, speech, and mind, and is the embodiment of the three, together with the nature of the retinue of body and the rest, and from the three, the life channel and the others, together with camphor, there is the gnosis that is their nature, characterized by the absence of conceptual thought. The purity of the root of the secret vajra of the body, arising from method and wisdom, is variety. At the throat, supreme joy, the supremely secret, is maturation. At the site of the tip, the joy of separation, the exceedingly secret, is consummation. And at the site of the navel, the joy of intrinsic nature, free of the three gnoses, appearance and the rest, and the embodiment of the three, is the distinctive characteristic. Or else, all of these are found from within that very intrinsic nature, whose nature is threefold.

The passage beginning
"O Goddess, that which is commitment
Is definitively taught as guarding and the rest"
means this: one should guard the commitments of vajra body and the rest and eat the five nectars and the like; guard and eat the nectar of the awakening mind, the commitment, which is the indestructible at the heart, in the center of the sun and moon; and, as for the commitment of gnosis, the joy of intrinsic nature, one should guard the nectar, the commitment of gnosis, in the center of supreme joy and the joy of separation, eat it, and be satisfied. This was also taught to the retinue; it comes from the lips of the guru.

The passage beginning
"That which in the ultimate sense is the fire offering
Is the adventitious, called ha"
means that all the rites, pacifying, enriching, and the rest, should be

performed as is fitting: the fire offering of eating, drinking, and the like; or else what is taught in the sense of the action of a stream of water; or the fire offering to be given to the wheels with the syllable ha, the mantra of the ḍākinīs. In the center of its mode and portion one seeks out the burnt offerings of conceptual thought, and when the offering is made in the center of the drop of the ha mantra, worshipped with the mantras of the channel ḍākinīs, the fruit of the joy of the fire offering is great bliss, reality itself.

The passage beginning
"That which is the churning and the means of churning
Is free of the first joy"
teaches the joy of intrinsic nature that comes from the sequence of joys arising from the method and wisdom of generation: the joy of the lotus of the palate and of the vajra; or else the churning of the wheel and the means of churning, the commitment seal; and likewise the sequence of the sites. For the joy of intrinsic nature, in which beginning and end are not two, the churning and the means of churning of supreme joy and of the joy of separation have all been abandoned.

The passage beginning
"Whatever is recited with the goddess's mantra
Is the mind gone beyond existence":
by the word "mantra" is meant what is born of method and wisdom. Wisdom is the mother, and method is the father. The union of the two, existence and nirvāṇa, is free of duality; and having consumed the winds of life and exertion (prāṇāyāma) by stopping them, and having likewise made them even, one should observe life and exertion. Or else, the meaning of reciting the mantra is this: the three joys, characterized as existence and nirvāṇa, are the embodiment of all three, the essence of the two, supreme joy and the joy of separation, free of duality. As it also says:

Free of drop, mode, and portion,
And within the drop, the mode, and the portion,
There the yogin should contemplate the mind.
One should contemplate within the portion,
Or else within the mode.
The mode too should be meditated into the drop,
And the drop too goes into emptiness.
Emptiness is the joy of intrinsic nature itself,
Free of the three, the supreme born of contemplation.

The passage beginning
"O Goddess, that which is the eight sites
Is the expansion of her who is born of the sun":
the eight sites are these. On the seats of the maṇḍala, the lotus seats, at the eight, the sacred sites, the fields, and the rest, in the east and the other directions, one generates them as gods and goddesses, and they dawn clearly; in this way the maṇḍala of the sites is complete.

As for "of her who is born of the sun": together with the lotus seats, and possessed of the lotus seat of the channel at the crown of the head, there are the eight sites, or else the eight-petalled lotus together with its center. This is the maṇḍala of the exalted awakening mind, and through the distinctions of wisdom, nondual wisdom expands and dawns.

The passage beginning
"That which is the sequence of joy and the rest
Is divided, in sequence, into two"
means this. Having found the mudrā foretold by the ḍākinīs and others, one carries out the various sacred commitments (samayas) together with the wisdom of union, and this applies from the first ground up to the eighth. Once parted from the mudrā, one may engage in all sorts of distinct and differing kinds of conduct; nevertheless, by the power of signlessness one is free of aspects, the very nature of one who has attained lordship over the tenth ground. Accordingly, there is the conduct described in the passage beginning "At times drunk with liquor, and," and it is also said:
"The great lord of yogins himself
Conceives all things by his own free power."
Again, the treatise of the master Avadhūtipa explains that the beginner yogin should rely on the action seal (karmamudrā), combining it with the sequence of the sense faculties; then he relies on the mudrās in the sequence that begins with the samaya, and at the eighth ground, through signlessness, he gains lordship over the ten grounds. Later in this very text it teaches such things as that the first, together with joy, is to be given to the beginner.

The meaning of the passage beginning
"That which is the charnel ground, free of conceptual thought,
Has wholly abandoned breathing out and the rest"
is as follows. One meditates on a particular charnel ground, where the corpse of the dead is free of breath and the rest, and of conceptual thought. And in

the charnel ground of the ground that has become the supreme abode of the awakening mind, and in the charnel ground of the completion stage, the conceptual thoughts of apprehended and apprehender burn away, and one savors the taste of the wisdom of bliss. This is generated as the wind arises and the dust-free camphor melts, and by its character of completion it is nondual.

In the passage beginning
"O Goddess, that which is the riverbank
Is at the end of the Nonconceptual One,"
the division of the sites where wisdom is to be attained is this: the opening at the tip of the secret jewel, and the domain of Brahmā, the site at the heart of the navel. In that sense, the end of the Nonconceptual One is where the awakening mind flows down as a river of bliss. Alternatively, it is the site where the river of bliss flows down from the place endowed with the threefold life channel, for it serves as the site of the sixteen joys. From the Nonconceptual One the water of the awakening mind flows down constantly; she dwells in the middle of the life channel. At those sites, the charnel ground and the riverbank, one meditates on the fourth, the wisdom body.

The passage beginning
"That which is the wisdom of appearance and the rest,
Earth and water and"
means this. The natures dissolve in sequence into the aggregates, the constituents, and the rest; these dissolve into appearance, the increase of appearance, and the attainment of appearance; and from that dissolution one sees the wisdom that dissolves into light itself, free of conceptual elaboration. Its meaning is taught in detail below. Others say this: "It is merely indicated by the four elements; it is taught as a sequence showing the order in which the wisdom of the four appearances arises."

In the passage beginning
"That which is the thing, the support, and the rest
Is to be known as the first bliss,"
the thing is the methods of union at the navel of the wisdom consort and the like: this is the first joy. The support is the centers of the knots of the channels: this is the middle joy. Wisdom is the very nature of the winds and the joys: this is the last joy. Differentiation is the drops of light and the like: this is the fourth joy. Furthermore, the thing is the wheel of great bliss together with the hub of the life channel, in the form of the four joys. The support is the wheel of

complete enjoyment together with the hub of the rasanā channel: this is supreme joy. Wisdom is the wheel of Dharma together with the hub of the Holder: this is the joy of separation. Differentiation is the wheel of emanation together with the Nonconceptual One: this is the joy of intrinsic nature. Here, through the distinctions of the secret places, it is taught by way of the distinctions of joy, supreme joy, and the rest; and the fourth, being experienced from oneself, is definitively set apart.

The passage beginning
"O Goddess, that which is the eight charnel grounds
Dissolves into bliss"
refers to the eight charnel grounds: the Inexhaustible, the Repulsive, the Jackal Pack, the Dreadful, the Piśācas' Crow, Aṭṭahāsa (Loud Laughter), the Blazing Black Fire, and the Terrifier. And there are the eight, the mouth, the nose, and the rest. Here, however, they should be distinguished according to the forms of camphor. Abiding in the vajra, it has the color of white bone; because it is itself hot, it is the blazing black fire; because great bliss abides in it, it is not unfit to be relied upon; the unions and the joys are the severed pieces, the heads, and the rest; because the two joys move up and down, there is sizzling and crackling; because it is not perfected by the joy of intrinsic nature, there are the half-burnt corpses; because the life wind does not move outward, there are the wholly burnt; and because the hare-marked moon spreads through all the branches of the channels, it is shown as white bones strewn about. And since all of these are of one taste in the bliss of the joy of intrinsic nature at the center of the eight-petalled lotus, the meaning of the eight charnel grounds, free of all the afflictions of conceptual thought, is great bliss, which is selflessness.

The passage beginning "That which is the meaning of the trees and the rest": in light of the meaning of the eight charnel grounds, the meaning of the eight trees is easy to understand.

The passage beginning
"That which is the wind of suchness, the meaning of the essence,
Is the bliss of its jewel bracelet"
means this. The meaning of the essence, the life channel and the rest, is that, relying on the mudrās, one is joined with the Wind One and the Sleep One; or else, once the blissful awakening mind has melted, the jewel of wisdom that comes with it is in the secret place through the joy of intrinsic nature, by means of the wind that illuminates the meaning of suchness.

In the passage beginning
"O Goddess, that which is entering and the rest
Is the wind held upward,"
entering is the Holder on the left side: endowed with the awakening mind and drawing the life wind upward, it is the joy of intrinsic nature. Abiding is to abide at all times in the Nonconceptual One herself. Going is the Taste-Bearer on the right side, by virtue of its being, in essence, the non-appearance of enjoyment and power. Or else: the Fierce One (caṇḍālī) performs the act of entering; the Nonconceptual One abides, in the sense of being free of apprehended and apprehender; and the Bird-Faced One and the joy of intrinsic nature are the going of wisdom. Moreover, to rely on this as the place of experience by holding the wind of intrinsic nature upward is to find great bliss through the practice of habituation.

The meaning of the passage beginning
"That which is the meditative concentration of drawing near
Sends the moon upward"
is as follows.

The hare-marked moon, which abides at the lower door of the heart of the secret lotus, the lotus of the jewel, goes to the heart of the joy of intrinsic nature. Or else, one requests the awakening mind of her bliss, between the sun and moon at the heart, to proceed in stages from the wheel of great bliss, blissfully, to the place free of conceptual elaboration. This is because its cause relies on the mudrā: such is the oral instruction. From there, through the oral instructions of the generation and completion stages, it is known as the meditative concentration of drawing near to the omniscience of the true abode of bliss.

The passage beginning
"That which is the wisdom drop (jñānatilaka)
Is free of two and a half sixes"
means this. The wisdom drop itself is the nature of all. Gathered up by way of the outer and the rest, the joy of intrinsic nature is free of the three. The sixteenth, which is also free of the fifteen joys and whose nature is inexpressible, the lord of the fifteen grounds, abides without shifting. The authority cited earlier has this in mind.

The passage beginning
"That which is my own supreme nature

Even when lost, is experienced"
teaches the Blessed Lady too, just as the meaning of the Blessed One is taught later. The Goddess, whose nature is that of a ḍākinī, in the form of a channel or in the essence of light, goes forth from the heart of the secret lotus for the sake of the urging, and, together with Vajradhara of great bliss, arrives at the place of the joy of intrinsic nature: that is what is meant. Then, going on to the place of nondual great bliss, she abides in the awakening mind of all sentient beings and seals it. This is spoken of as the nondual Great Seal.

The passage beginning
"That which masters the grounds
Is the nature of the six realities"
means this. As for the six realities: in terms of the six yogas, since they are correlated with the six, which embody the forty realities, they are correlated in sequence with the grounds. As it is said:
"The supreme other cannot be expressed in words;
It is utterly pure, suchness itself.
Because it is the very nature of all,
Therefore one should not make distinctions."
This too is taught further on in this very text. Elsewhere it is found explained in correlation with the sequence of the joys and by the sequence of the grounds.

The passage beginning
"That which is the body of the Tathāgatas
Is joy free of joy"
means this. The aggregates and the afflictions, desire and the rest, are all the body accomplished from the five wisdoms; in the sequence of the white bliss of the awakening mind, the black, and the rest, it is the reality of the joy of the four joys. Or else: by the word "Tathāgata," which means nirvāṇa, the joy of separation is designated only figuratively; beyond that, the joy of intrinsic nature, great bliss itself, is the meaning of nirvāṇa.

The passage beginning
"O Goddess, that which is the teaching of the tantra
Is bliss that greatly increases"
means this. Just as, through the sequence of the root tantra and the rest, the meaning becomes vast and profound, so too the wisdom of bliss, outer and so on, increases and expands by being experienced in sequence. Here, the light of the bliss of intrinsic nature that has a basis is the lamp, and its essential

nature, great bliss without a basis, is what is made clear: that is what this means. Or else, it means that the causal tantra itself is accomplished as the result.

The passage beginning
"That which is the nature of the Great Seal
Is nonappearing, beyond the collections and mentation"
means this. The joy of intrinsic nature of the Great Seal, which embodies the three bodies, is free of signs such as being expressed; through the experience indicated by the joy of intrinsic nature of the jewel bracelet, it is the nature of all, the essence of all, and has relinquished all. As it is also said:
"It does not rise, it does not set;
The unborn portion ever dawns,
The light of the perfectly stainless aspect,
Free of times and circumstances."
And again:
"What is hard for yogins to find
Is found through supreme means;
Without supreme means, never at all."
That is, together with the means as they were conferred.

The passage beginning
"That which is secret in the ultimate sense
Is the inner tangible"
means this. The supreme secret, hard to find, is the inner tangible, soft and subtle, because the awakening mind is shown within the jewel of the secret vajra. In it, the joy of intrinsic nature, free of the aspects of signs and free of the tangible, has become the utmost secret. Or else, it is the inexpressible joy that has abandoned the signs of the distinctions of joy, pure and stainless. As it is explained:
"Like the passionate joy of the young,
And like the dream of a mute."
Then the joy of intrinsic nature, the nature of all, is untainted, like space.

The passage beginning
"That which is the meaning of the offering of urging
Is the arising of stainless bliss"
means this. The retinues of ḍākinīs urge him who has become the joy of intrinsic nature itself, with one voice, with "Endowed with the six" and the rest; this is the means of seeing. Then he is seen just as he is, as distinct from

intrinsic nature, and likewise as abiding once more in the sense of the joy of intrinsic nature. When the Blessed One of great bliss is urged by sound accompanied by rays of light, together with the wheels of the channels, to see him abiding in the place of joy distinguished by the wheels and the rest is the arising of the stainless. As it is said:

"Vajradhara, great bliss,
Abides in all the supreme and holy sites;
The Blessed One dwells in great bliss;
The emanation body abides at the Vajrāsana (the seat of awakening)."

In view of the meaning of the joy of intrinsic nature, the three bodies are indivisible.

"There is birth again in what has passed" means that the path he formerly traveled by way of intrinsic nature arises again, because it expands in every way. Later, going back once more to the site of the wheel of great bliss is called "increasing in that birth": by way of supreme joy, the channel ḍākinīs and all the rest abide as the body of great bliss.

The passage beginning

"O Goddess, that which is wisdom and gnosis
Is bliss at the mouth and at the heart"

distinguishes wisdom (prajñā) and gnosis (jñāna), as explained before. Here it means the wisdom empowerment at the site of the jewel's mouth, and gnosis at its heart. Then come the basis and the joy of intrinsic nature. Or again: at the mouth of wisdom, wisdom; then, on the return, at the heart of method, gnosis, whose nature is the fourth.

The passage beginning

"That which is the maṇḍala of the secret
Is the unshifting bliss of camphor"

means this. The words "secret maṇḍala" refer to the essential fluid that is the meaning of those wheels of colored powders, flowers, and various fragrances; not shifting to the upper or lower places, it is the secret maṇḍala together with the joy of intrinsic nature, the flowers, and the rest. Or else, the words "great bliss" and the rest mean great bliss, the meaning of the joy of intrinsic nature.

The words "wisdom that has abandoned conceptual thought, great bliss, the awakening mind" are explained through the distinction of cause and result. This, moreover, is what is meant by the words "the domain of Brahmā."

The passage beginning
"O Goddess, that which burns and expands
Is absorbed within the Bird-Faced One"
means this. At the center of the vajra and the lotus, one makes the distinction between the two indivisible, and through the expansion of the awakening mind of intrinsic nature, it is reality. Or else, the burning and expanding at any supreme site whatsoever is the wisdom of bliss free of melting and the rest, the reality that has abandoned entities.

In the passage beginning
"To guard the bhūtas (spirits), offer the torma (ritual cake);
That is the killing of living beings,"
the word "bhūta" here means camphor: this, which has the nature of the essence of all sentient beings, is to be guarded in the jewel wheel and held; that is what it says. One should offer as torma, and give to the hosts of ḍākinīs, the flesh and the like of various sentient beings whose lives have been cut off. "The continuum of the six classes of beings is to be cut off and brought to cessation": this refers to all sentient beings who possess the essence; so it is explained in coded language. These are what is meant by "the great secret of the supreme great secret" and the rest. For it is said:
"As with a precious jewel:
In accordance with the wishes of beings,
Poverty and want are left behind,
And every excellence comes forth."
And again:
"Just as, on the clear face of the sky,
The cloudless hare-marked moon, so bright,
Is seen in a flawless vessel of water
In this way, as its reflected image,
So too, for one who has gathered the accumulations,
The king of great bliss himself,
The Dharma and complete enjoyment,
The vajra of body, speech, and mind,
Dawns as a wish-fulfilling jewel of blessing;
Likewise emanations, further emanations, and the rest:
Just as they have found those dharmas,
So they appear to sentient beings, each apart."
And again:

"That itself is the recitation of mantra;
That itself is austerity in all its kinds;
That itself is the maṇḍala; that is the maṇḍala.
Since it gathers all, the mind is the gathering."
And again:
"Form, feeling, perception,
Formations, and consciousness,
The elements, the sense sources, and all the rest,
All appear clearly as mind itself."
And again:
"All this, whose nature is outer and inner,
Does not exist apart from mind.
The certain nature of things
Is utterly pure suchness."
And:
"All outer objects are momentary;
O Joyous One, they are the mind's magical display.
There is nothing else, yet mind too is not so:
Mind itself is just like space."
And again:
"In no world-system whatsoever
Is a buddha found elsewhere.
Since mind itself is the perfect buddha,
A buddha is not found anywhere else.
There is no buddha elsewhere:
It is one's own awakening mind itself.
Just as finding a bright, clear jewel
Puts an end to all poverty,
So the treasure of the awakening mind
Brings freedom from all poverty."

Here the earlier meaning is shown clearly. The passage beginning, The Goddess asked, "The reality that embodies the forty," is her request about the meaning of correlating them with the grounds. The passage beginning
"Thirty-six of various aspects,
The lord of the eleventh"
is the answer he declared.

In the verse
"In the self, through the thirty-two,
For thirty-two hours,
The life wind and the reviving wind,
The two having dawned, enjoy all,"
"the thirty-two" are the thirty-two channels of great bliss of the thirty-two realities. "The self" is the fixation on the self of reality in the form of eight pairs, together with the center and the filaments. "Thirty-two hours": in terms of the inner hours and so on, the shifts, the sessions, and the staffs, they are taught as having the character of the channels, the awakening mind, and the winds. "The two winds, life and reviving": from the right and left of the central channel, from the place of great bliss together with the winds, up to great bliss, the life wind and the reviving wind arise in all the limbs. In terms of the wind of the heart and the wind of the navel, this is clearly taught here, as it says:
"The life wind abides at the heart;
Likewise the reviving wind at the navel.
When the wind comes forth
From the soles of the feet, at that time
The life wind goes upward
And the reviving wind remains at the navel.
Or else, when the life wind
Goes downward from the crown of the head,
That reviving wind goes to its own place:
The reviving wind is taught to be at the navel."
"Having dawned" means that the two make use of all the limbs. "All" is all the conceptual thoughts of the aggregates, elements, sense sources, channels, and fluids. "The time of spring" is so called because all of these experience the essence of the distinctions of the wisdom of bliss. As it is said:
"The bad time is explained as separation;
The good time is supreme joy;
Free of the two, here is the time
For enjoying the wisdom of bliss in all."
"At the time when the reviving wind arises" means this: the time when it arises in the place of the wind that revives all that is included in life, the aggregates and the rest, and in body, speech, and mind, is freedom from the conceptualization of entities with signs. "The essence at the inner hub" is this very awakening mind of bliss, the essence together with the life channel at the

inner hub of the wheels. Or else, the hub of all is the center of the vajra jewel. "It enters by the path of the root and the stalk" means that the essence itself enters from the root of the life channel and the path of the three stalks, here in the inner and the secret, by the path of the central one, into the place of the tip of the jewel. As for "By merely entering, to great bliss, the king of life, who is present within the eight-cornered": "within the eight-cornered" is the site at the center of the hub of the three-petalled lotus, which has the meaning of the eight supports. "Great bliss, the king of life, who is present there" is the awakening mind free of conceptual elaboration, having the aspect of the basis, the king of bliss that has become the antidote to the afflictions. The word "to" is in the sense of support, because it is the very continuum that supports the fourth. Regarding "That which has the characteristic of one taste is the gathering," it is explained that all the limbs and the rest that were taught as realities are gathered in the center of the secret vajra jewel, because it acts as the king of all realities. The meaning of "smiling" is going by the upward path.

As it is said:
"Through the churning of method and wisdom,
The well-pleased, utterly blissful
Awakening mind, together with bliss,
Comes forth by the stalk, the central path.
If the life wind, at the root of the navel,
Does not go elsewhere,
This lotus, which stays face down,
Will come to stand upright.
In the middle of its hub
The awakening mind becomes stable."

The passage beginning "At that time, whoever makes no distinction between self and other" is easy to understand, and so it has not been explained.

Regarding the passage beginning "The Goddess asked," which requests the meaning of empowerment, and the passage beginning "The first, together with joy, is to be given to the beginner": the empowerments of the vase, the secret, wisdom-gnosis, and the fourth, which through the sequence of the inner and the rest are made to have the sequence of the joys as their result, are given in order to generate strength in those who abide in the sequence of the grounds and the rest; that is, one confers the empowerments of the inner vase, the secret vase, and so on, and teaches the oral instructions. Other masters say: "By conferring the vase empowerment one accomplishes the result of the

eighth ground, the cause and the rest; through the sequence of the three appearances, the tenth is the wisdom of great bliss free of conceptual elaboration." Some have said that it is taught by way of the distinction between the Great Vehicle and the Vajra Vehicle. Again, some say that it is given by the precious empowerment of the fourth. Some say that having found four action seals as foretold, one obtains the fourth empowerment. I hold that this accords with the king's treatise. Why? Because it comes from an unbroken lineage of hearing.

With the passage beginning "The Goddess asked," the request is made. In reply: "For those who have not attained the grounds and the rest, at first by its own nature." This is taught extensively in terms of conferring empowerment and so on, in accordance with the rites taught for the preparation for empowerment, the maṇḍala, and the rest, that is, with a maṇḍala of colored powders and the like. The passage beginning "For those who have attained the grounds and the rest" concerns those who, in former lives, from countless eons, have been devoted to virtue, have gathered merit, and possess the strength of diligence and the rest; it is taught extensively right here through example and meaning.

If one wonders what the final result is here, it is shown here: it is explained by the passage beginning
"Free of the body of great wisdom,
Nondual, like space."
As it is said:
"It is utterly free of all that is imputed;
This itself is nondual wisdom,
Peace itself, whose nature is wisdom and method;
This itself is the supreme awakening mind.
This is the wisdom beyond the world,
The Great Vehicle, the dharmakāya itself,
The vajra, Vajrasattva himself,
The unsurpassed awakening of the buddhas."
In this way the cause and the rest are explained from every side.

The passage beginning "I know your own nature" consists of words of request.
The Blessed One said:
"What is there other than finding awakening?
Yet there is a seeing in it,
Just as with nectar in food."

This means that unsurpassed awakening is what is to be accomplished, and that there is a finding other than seeing Samantaprabhā (Universal Light). The final result of the Great Vehicle of the sūtras and the rest is Samantaprabhā; but the meaning of the Secret Mantra Vajra Vehicle is that "yet it is seen otherwise": the very nature of nondual great bliss, which has abandoned arising and ceasing, an essence not separate from all. As it is also said:

"From the one great bliss alone
Distinctions are merely taught one by one;
The teaching of the five families and the rest
Exists, it is said, for the sake of taming."

Just as food of one single kind is seen in various forms, and even what is by nature nectar is seen in many ways according to the distinctions of conceptualizing minds, it is just as the Tathāgatas see it as nectar; for they are free of conceptual thought. As it is said:

"The afflictions, desire and the rest,
When grasped, become poison;
But if contemplated through the stages of wisdom,
Those very afflictions become wisdom itself."

The Goddess asks about the meaning of empowerment.

"The answer he declared to that:
The fourth is known as reality"

means that the fourth empowerment is the supreme reality in the sense of the joy of intrinsic nature that has a site and that which is free of a site. "Thus it is perceived as wisdom" teaches that, like the wisdom of the joy of separation, so is the wisdom of the joy of intrinsic nature. "Likewise, know what arises from wisdom" is the site of the four essences at the hub of the three-petalled lotus. Likewise, in terms of the sequence of sites, by way of wisdom, what arises from wisdom, and the four, although the result is complete, it is known as the generation side. Its being known as completion, because it is distinguished by the moon, or else by the word "likewise," is the point of the passage beginning "Just as it passed into wisdom before."

The passage beginning "Blessed One, jewel sun of wisdom" first speaks the qualities in praise of the essence of example and meaning, and then makes a request about the meaning of the secret basis, the basis of joy, and the rest.

The Blessed One said, "The four appearances abide in sequence." Here "appearance," "mind," "emptiness," "moon," and the like are synonyms; in

various ways the meaning of joy and of appearance is taught. Moreover, from the side of what is unclear, the distinctive characteristic of the mind of joy, the wisdom of appearance, is correlated with its occasions. Mental factors are the wisdom of the increase of appearance: supreme joy, the wisdom of bliss, superior to that. The characteristic of ignorance is the wisdom of the attainment of appearance: the joy of separation, the wisdom of bliss, whose nature is most supreme, surpassing that.

In the passage beginning "Mind is the very nature of signs," the distinctions among these wisdoms are taught, and here they are to be understood by distinguishing example and meaning. Mind is that which has the perception of the wisdom of appearance; it is not the clear wisdom. Thus, just as in autumn the stainless sky is pervaded by the light of the full moon's rays, it is clear, and because all things are observed, it is the wisdom of appearance. "Mental factors, of the nature of day" means that which has the nature of the wisdom of the increase of appearance: again, just as in autumn it is pervaded by the rays of the sun, it is exceedingly clear and stainless, and all things without exception are observed; this is the essence of the wisdom of the increase of appearance.

"Ignorance, which has the perception of twilight" means that which has the perception of the attainment of appearance. Just as, when night falls into darkness, all is pervaded by an essence that is subtle and without self, so too, where the life force and exertion do not move, there is the wisdom of the attainment of appearance, whose nature is unmoving. "Perfect radiant light, free of the three" means that which has the nature of the wisdom of radiant light: again, just as, at the instant when the darkness that characterizes twilight has been dispelled, there is the nature of the sun not yet risen, it is free of conceptual thought, signs, and the like; it is great bliss alone, clear as the stainless wisdom of radiant light. Of this it is said, "It has the characteristic of the joy of intrinsic nature." Accordingly, this very text says:

"At first, together with joy,
It is to be given to the beginner,"
and so on.

Now I shall explain the meaning together with the sites. As for what is taught in the passage beginning "When the mind is at Brahmā's joint," the word "Brahmā" means possessing the mentation of the joy of the awakening mind. The site at the root of the vajra is that joint. Going there to the site of supreme joy is what the word "affliction" refers to, the increase of appearance; it means

that the life force radiates in the form of the navel. Here "life" is taught as the wind and the rest, because it shifts upon meeting the awakening mind. Or else, the joint is the juncture of the vajra and the jewel bracelet. That is the site of joy, and I shall explain it in order.

The passage beginning "Neither above nor below" refers to the juncture at the site of the joy of separation, between the two doors of the mouth of the precious buddha of the vajra and the jewel. Explaining these in coded terms, appearance is taught as the moon. In "From appearance, the time of dawning comes," the dawning of the awakening mind that experiences the wisdom of the bliss of appearance is the good time: having become joy, aspiration sets in. In

"That by which there is the sun,
That is the sun, the Holder of Life,"

the wisdom of the increase of appearance, the sun, has become a distinctive bliss. "Life" is the wind of the nature of the awakening mind, exceedingly excellent, and that very supreme joy is what the word "sun" teaches; "holding" means having become stable.

"Twilight is the attainment of appearance itself;
That too is known as the nature of fire"

means that the wisdom of the attainment of appearance, a bliss that has become still more distinctive, is taught by the word "fire." The correlation of the words "moon," "sun," and "fire" with the three appearances is also taught extensively by the glorious Indrabhūti in the Garland of Flowers of Joy. Those who wish to understand the sequence of the appearances should look there, and should also correlate it with the text.

"Complete melting" lasts from when the awakening mind melts from the wheel of great bliss until joy arises. "The stirring of nectar" is the shifting of the nectar of freedom from the afflictions to the supreme site. "Because the Great Goddess stirs it" is easy to understand. "Where the joy of separation does not appear" teaches that, just as wisdom has not arisen in joy, so too it has not arisen in the supreme.

Their meaning is taught extensively. "That is appearance, the first joy" is the wisdom of joy, the first of the four joys. As for "From that, supreme joy becomes clear," the sequence from joy to supreme joy, having become the increase of appearance, is what is meant by the passage beginning "Through transformation, the time when supreme joy dawns." "Without melting, without stirring, it is dense" means that by relying on the wisdom of the attainment of

appearance, the essence of the joy of separation, one finds the fourth, free of conceptual elaboration, reality, the meaning of the result. "From the dense, the substance of meeting" means that through the third itself one comes to find the fourth, the nondual joy of intrinsic nature, perfect radiant light.

Some say that the passage beginning "Its appearance is the first joy" is taught by correlating it with the four wheels and the sequence of the joys, and is then explained again by correlating it with the sequence of the emanation wheel. Or else, one should divide it according to the completion stage. In the sequence taught in the passage beginning "Where the joy of separation does not appear," "the joy of separation does not appear" is the fourth, in the joy of intrinsic nature, supported by the appearance of the first wisdom. To that very state the words "at first, joy" are applied. That same joy of intrinsic nature, made very stable, is the meaning of "supreme joy becomes clear." In "Through transformation, the time when supreme joy dawns," the word "through transformation" is the completion stage:

"The dawning, at the site of supreme joy,
Of the sun of radiant wisdom
Is the time inconceivable among times,
Which has abandoned good and bad."

When that same sun becomes clear through the sequence of the circles, it is said, "Because it is clear, it is known as the great appearance." Because it is clear, that same wisdom, abiding as the nature of the wisdom of the wheel of great bliss, is "without melting, without stirring, dense." Through that same joy of intrinsic nature of great bliss, together with its support, "In the dense, the subtle substance" is what the lord of yogins sees: the supremely profound, holy reality, the king of great bliss, free of all conceptual elaboration.

"The giver of bliss also enjoys all" is as explained there, where the life wind and the reviving wind dawn in all the limbs. In the passage beginning "From enjoying all," all the various aspects of the wisdom of appearance are attained as the nature of the wisdom of the joy of intrinsic nature. Its own meaning is the juncture between day and night. Because it abides between the site of supreme joy and the joy of separation, it is present in the middle site. Without it, no one at all knows supreme joy. With the meaning explained below in view, the passage beginning "The middle site, which is present" is taught.

Or else, the passage beginning "Where night" means this: since "where" and "that" set the two apart, the wisdom of the appearance of night is to be abandoned, and the sun, the wisdom without appearance, is also abandoned;

for that reason it is taught by the words "the setting of the sun." The joy of separation, characterized as the middle, is the wisdom of the attainment of appearance, and therefore it is said, "She who bestows the joy of intrinsic nature," and so on. That blissful aspect of the awakening mind is explained as the joy of separation at the hub of the emanation wheel, the attainment of appearance. "It is the cause from which all arises" means that all the phenomena of existence and nirvāṇa arise and are emanated from it.

The passage that states these things with their meaning made clear is the one beginning, "Where, in the instant of the middle juncture." Although neither saṃsāra nor nirvāṇa exists, nirvāṇa is the Dharma body and existence is the form body, and saṃsāra and the rest come about through deluded conceptual thought. There, moreover, it arises adventitiously and is a clinging to entities as apprehended and apprehender. Therefore one circles in the ocean of saṃsāra in the three realms. Its cause is the supreme reality, and in the same way existence and nirvāṇa abide in the manner of cause and result. These are designated as two, the bodily form of the conventional and the ultimate, and what is free from it; yet under analysis nothing at all is established.

Moreover, what arises through the generation stage is this: from the supreme light comes the consciousness of the stage of the attainment of appearance, and upon that, wind, fire, water, earth, the aggregates, and so on. What arises in sequence is the entity of existence, the form body itself, endowed with the three appearances, which has arisen from its cause, the perfect supreme light. Again, from the entity of existence as the cause, the attainment of appearance is the result, and through the purity of that result great bliss itself is attained. All of these have the three appearances as their cause. Because one does not know them together with their intrinsic nature, one wanders and circles through existence; because of delusion one does not attain nonduality. That is why the passage beginning, "If one does not know the feeling of bliss," was spoken. To show the cause of these, it is called "the treasury of the nectar of great bliss." The passage beginning, "Because it is born from churning," explains both in order: the entity of existence, in which the deities arise through the form of the generation stage, and the characteristic of nirvāṇa, the completion stage. The meaning of their fruit is the renown of having attained the fruit, that is, being endowed with the major and minor marks.

The lines,
Because it is free from entity and nonentity,
O fair-faced one, it is the wisdom of the juncture,

mean that even the side of nirvāṇa alone is to be divided in the same way, into a form body and a formless body. Their meaning is also explained by this:

Day is the increase of appearance, known as saṃsāra;
What is called night is appearance;
The juncture is the attainment of appearance, nirvāṇa.

These lines state that the method of existence, characterized as day, is the entity of the increase of appearance, having the nature of the Taste-Bearer, supreme joy. Night, in the sense of the moon, is the joy of appearance, having the nature of an entity; in the form of the life channel it is the intrinsic nature of the Body. The juncture is nirvāṇa, characterized as darkness: it is the Mind, whose nature is to apprehend the entity of the joy of separation. The juncture where vajra and lotus meet, or else where the two navels meet, the juncture between supreme joy and the joy of separation, is the juncture of sun and moon and of day and night, and has the intrinsic nature of the bliss of nirvāṇa. As for the nondual wisdom that arises there, or else that itself:

Free from existence and nirvāṇa,
Nowhere has it been made clear.

This means that it is not made clear in any of the tantras of Action, Conduct, Yoga, Great Yoga, or Unsurpassed Yoga. That the appearances abide in sequence in the ground is the point taught here. That is why the passage beginning, "Such a supreme great secret," was spoken.

In the passage beginning, "The Goddess asked: What jewel is that renowned fruit?", she asks about and requests the meaning of the fruit and the ground of saṃsāra and nirvāṇa, that is, of all the joys, the appearances, and so on. In answer, the passage beginning, "The Blessed One declared," was spoken, conveying the nature of experience together with its support, and that which, having abandoned conceptual thought about it, abides by its intrinsic nature in all and is free from all. As for what is renowned as the essence of supreme joy, the line "It is found through experience" means this: just as gnosis was experienced and ascertained at the time of the wisdom-gnosis empowerment, so too, from experiencing it at the heart of the sixty-fourfold emanation wheel at the navel, it is found by cultivating it again and again without interruption. As it is said:

Therein, the teaching of reality is this:
Supreme joy is the extreme, the joy of separation the middle.
The meaning hidden throughout all the tantras

I shall make clear here, conclusively.
And again:
Having utterly abandoned all of these,
Having gained stability, firmly abiding in the union of meditative concentration,
Those endowed with knowledge should cultivate
Mere self-awareness, day and night.
And again:
In great bliss, mere self-awareness,
I, endowed with wisdom,
Having cultivated it day and night,
Became the supreme nondual itself.
So it is said.

The passage beginning, "Supreme joy and separation," means: supreme joy, the meaning of completion, which is the experience of joy whose nature is free from any locus; the sublime reality, free from all conceptual thought. The passage beginning, "O fortunate lady, what is experienced," has been explained there. Again, reality too, in its consummate state, is explained in these words:
The great unsurpassed wisdom
Is ever risen, free from a ground.
Because there is nothing else above and beyond this very wisdom, it is the unsurpassed supreme; and because it is the indivisible wisdom that gathers into itself the nature of all wisdoms, such as the five kinds of wisdom, it is the great nondual wisdom. Because it is inexpressible, free from conceptual elaboration, without arising or ceasing, without exhaustion or increase, and untainted by any phenomenon, it is free from a ground. Because it is taught with such words as "neither rising nor setting, liberated from entity and nonentity, the Great Seal itself, great bliss itself," it is ever risen. As it is said:
The Great Seal, the supreme secret,
Is great bliss itself, the most excellent:
Inexpressible, inexhaustible, unborn,
Having the form of all, it is free from form,
Wholly devoid of shape and color;
Formless in nature, it is supreme among forms,
Its intrinsic nature immeasurable.

Where could it come to abide?
It neither rises nor sets;
In its aspect as the sense sources it is ever risen.
The light of the perfectly stainless aspect
Is the cause of arising and perishing,
And is liberated from time and circumstance.

So it is said. And again:
The wisdom light of self-awareness
Cannot be expressed by the path of words.
That stage of blessing
Is the essential nature of omniscient wisdom.
So it is said. And again:
Nondual and inexpressible,
Vajrasattva, glory of the vajra,
The supreme and sublime awakening mind,
The very awakening of the perfect buddhas:
That itself is the perfection of wisdom,
The very substance of all the perfections;
That itself is nondual awareness;
That itself is here declared to be sameness,
The supreme meditation of all the buddhas.
So it is said. In the same way, this very meaning of the fruit is clearly taught in all the tantras and the rest. The teaching that without realizing this sublime reality there is no accomplishment, whether through oneself or through others, is the passage beginning, "What else is there but the ever risen?"

The passage beginning, "The Goddess asked: This tantra, the great secret," means in substance this: when the Blessed One Vajradhara has passed into nirvāṇa, which is to be parted from the three bodies, and no longer speaks, who is there to explain it to sentient beings endowed with the karma and the fortune for it? "Who is there" has the sense of "who will it be?" The answer to this point, given in the passage beginning, "The Blessed One declared: In time to come, in the northern region," is easy to understand.

In the passage beginning, "May the most supreme essence of the ocean of the nectar of reality be victorious!", the Blessed One himself is praised. The intrinsic nature of the three bodies, that of the great Vajradhara, abides pervading all the sentient beings of the three realms; through the meaning of

the generation stage and the rest, it has entered the stages of the tantra; and it dwells, as the essence of the fruit, in all the buddhas, the Tathāgatas. Because this praises the Blessed One, the indivisible nature of all of these, it is a praise of the reality that is the nature of all and free from all.

From the essence of all the tantras,
That which has become the supreme quintessence of the essence
Is this very tantra of definitive meaning,
The sublime and supreme fruit of all.
To those who are deluded by ignorance
And lack empowerment and the rest,
All who make its meaning clear
Have been deceived by Māra.
Whoever does not put this meaning into practice
Will not attain its fruit,
But, worn out in body and mind, amid the afflictions,
Will circle in the ocean of existence, it is said.
In expressing these profound meanings,
Even if there has been carelessness and error,
O all you hosts of Victors together with your heirs,
Where there are contradictions, please be forbearing.
Relying on words and letters,
The meaning of this has been clearly explained.
By the virtue gained through its merit,
May all beings become buddhas!

This completes the commentary on the difficult points of the Glorious Tantra of Reality, called The Jewel Garland, composed by Mahāsukhatavajra, supreme among the great masters of India. It was translated by the monk Jangchub Jungné.

## Translator's Notes

• "The bhaga of wisdom" keeps the Sanskrit word used in the Tibetan: in this tantric idiom it is the secret space of the female consort, wisdom, in which the Blessed One and his maṇḍala abide. Saṃvara is rendered "binding vow" because the commentary takes it in its sense of binding together all the meaning of the tantra; āli and kāli are the vowels and the consonants. The item rendered "the staff" in the list of fourfold sets is obscure. The quoted verse about "Brahmā's battlefield" is obscure and is translated literally. The fourth opening verse is compressed: it likens the commentary to a garland whose thread runs through, or pervades, the jewels of the tantra's vajra words.
• The quoted words ("the three realities," "the moon, supreme bliss," "supreme over others,"

"the end," "complete," "renowned as the Discerner," and so on) are key words of the root tantra's opening, which the commentator reads in several ways; their Sanskrit cannot be confirmed, so they are translated literally. "The mode" renders a word that, with the digit and the drop, forms a triad of subtle phases, and may stand for a technical term. "Camphor" is a code word for the white drop of the awakening mind. "The moon, supreme bliss" is not here the deity Cakrasaṃvara, whose Tibetan name looks the same. The goddess named in the last lemma ("great mighty one, born of the sun") cannot be identified with confidence, so the words are translated. "The joy of separation" appears to correspond to the third of the four joys (viramānanda).

• In the gloss on "the abode of Brahmā" the text reads bzhi ("four"), which makes no sense in a list of synonyms; it is read as gzhi ("basis"). In the list of time units, thun tshod is a watch of the day, not a meditation session. "The joy of intrinsic nature" is this commentary's name for the highest of the joys, apparently the innate joy (sahajānanda) of other sources; "the six" with which the enjoyer is endowed are presumably the six excellences traditionally said to be meant by bhaga. The cited line on the sixteenth ground breaks off at brtag pa mi, the commentator abbreviating the quotation; it is rendered "beyond examination." The two opinions on "life force" and "staff" are read as parallel glosses of two words of the root text; the first leaves its subject unstated, and "the life force" is supplied from the second.

• The gloss on the word "secret" sets the joys and the degrees of secrecy against the four moments of the Hevajra system: variety, maturation, consummation, and a fourth that the Tibetan gives as rnam pa'i mtshan nyid, rendered here "the distinctive characteristic," the moment usually called free of characteristics (vilakṣaṇa). The phrase rendered "the action of a stream of water" (chu rgyun pa las pa) is obscure. In the cited verse, "mode" renders tshul; its technical sense beside drop and portion is uncertain. The recitation verse reads lha mo'i, "of the goddess," where the neighbouring verses open by addressing the Goddess; it is translated as written.

• Here "mudrā" denotes the consort with whom the practices of union are performed, as in the action seal (karmamudrā). Several feminine names of channels and goddesses could not be identified with confidence and are translated by their meaning: the Nonconceptual One, the Holder, the Taste-Bearer (on the right side, so evidently the right channel, rasanā), the Bird-Faced One, the Wind One, the Sleep One, and the life channel (srog ma, also written srog pa). The charnel-ground names other than Aṭṭahāsa are likewise translated literally. "The natures" that dissolve into the aggregates appear to be the natural conceptions (prakṛti) of the dissolution sequence. "In the form of the four joys" (dga' bzhi'i rnam pa) is translated as written, though the parallel series, which assigns one joy to each wheel, suggests a slip for "joy" (dga' ba'i). In the quoted verse, "conceives all things by his own free power" renders the uncertain kun du brtags literally.

• In the verse "That which is the wisdom drop," ye shes thig le is a term of the practice, the drop of wisdom, not the title of the Jñānatilaka Tantra cited elsewhere in this commentary; the Sanskrit is given to show the connection. "Two and a half sixes" renders drug phyed gsum literally; it amounts to fifteen, which the commentary takes as the fifteen joys surpassed by the sixteenth. Where wisdom and gnosis are set side by side, they render shes rab (prajñā) and ye shes (jñāna); elsewhere ye shes is rendered "wisdom." "Endowed with the six" (drug ldan), the opening words of the ḍākinīs' urging, is not identified; it may be an epithet of the Blessed One as possessor of the six excellences. "The true abode of bliss" (bde ba can) could also be read as the name Sukhāvatī.

• In "that which burns and expands," tshig is read as "burn," as it is elsewhere in this commentary and as the gloss "free of melting" suggests; it could also be read as "words." "The reviving wind" renders sos pa'i rlung literally; its Sanskrit name is not identified. "O Joyous One" takes dga' ma as an address to the Goddess. "Hours" renders chu tshod, the Indian water-clock

period (nāḍikā), and "the staffs" renders dbyu gu, evidently another division of time (daṇḍa).
• "Words of request" reads zhu ba'i tshig; the text has khu ba'i tshig, "words of the fluid," which makes no sense here, while the passage is plainly the Goddess's request before the Blessed One's reply. "The king's treatise" (rgyal po'i gzhung) is not identified; it may mean a work by a royal author such as Indrabhūti, or a king of tantras. Samantaprabhā, Universal Light, is the eleventh ground, the culmination of the sūtra path. The sentence on completion "distinguished by the moon" (zla, which could also mean "partner") and the quoted line "Just as it passed into wisdom before" are obscure and are rendered literally.
• "'Holding' means having become stable" reads brtan par gyur pa; the text has bstan par gyur pa, "has been taught," which makes no sense here. Indrabhūti's Garland of Flowers of Joy (dga' ba'i me tog gi phreng ba) is not identified with certainty, and its title is translated. "The circles" renders 'khor, which may here be short for 'khor lo, "the wheels." "Dense" renders bska ba, "thick" or "astringent," said of the awakening mind that neither melts nor stirs.
• □□□□□□, rendered "the supreme reality" (as if for paramārtha), may be a slip for □□□□□□, "the supreme light", which the passage names just below as the cause from which existence arises. "The supreme light" appears to be this text's term for the clear light (prabhāsvara), from which the attainment of appearance and the other appearances arise in sequence. □□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□ are read as forms of address to the Goddess ("O fair-faced one", "O fortunate lady"), as is usual in tantric dialogue. The lemma □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as "supreme joy and separation", following the commentary's gloss of each part; grammatically it could also mean "free from supreme joy".
• The phrase rendered "which is to be parted from the three bodies" is terse in the Tibetan; it is read as describing the Blessed One's passing into nirvāṇa, after which he no longer speaks. The colophon gives the root text's title in a short form, "the Glorious Tantra of Reality", without the word "Lamp" found in the opening title.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.